



PME Project Management (Glossary)

Subtitle : Core Terms & Agile Vocabulary for Strategic Execution

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Core Project Management Vocabulary

- Project** – A set of tasks, actions, and processes aimed at achieving a result or creating a product.
- Goal** – A desired result.
- Task** – A problem to solve in order to achieve a goal.
- Stakeholder** – A person or group interested in the project.
- Life Cycle** – The sequence of stages from idea to implementation.
- MVP (Minimum Viable Product)** – A basic version of a product used to gather user feedback.
- Methodology** – A theory-based concept with principles and methods for managing projects.
- Project Management Method** – The tools and techniques used to achieve results.
- Waterfall** – A sequential, non-overlapping approach to project phases.
- Scrum** – A framework for organizing work, central to Agile methodology.
- Product Backlog** – A master list of tasks for the team.
- Sprint Backlog** – Selected tasks for the current sprint cycle.
- Product Increment** – A usable product outcome from a sprint.
- WBS (Work Breakdown Structure)** – A tool that outlines the work needed to reach project goals.
- Critical Path (CP)** – A sequence of tasks that must be completed in order and on time.
- CPM (Critical Path Method)** – A technique to identify critical and non-critical tasks.
- Project Team** – A group assembled to achieve project goals within a timeframe.
- Assumption** – A factor considered true during planning without proof.
- Risk** – The possibility of an impact on the project.
- Risk Management** – Identifying, analyzing, and controlling risks.
- Change Management** – Reviewing, approving, and managing changes to project documents.



Section 1: Foundations of Project Management

What Is Project Management?

Project management is the structured application of knowledge, tools, and techniques to deliver a defined outcome within constraints of time, cost, and scope. It's not just about managing tasks—it's about aligning people, processes, and purpose.

Role of the Project Manager

- Leads the team toward shared goals
- Manages stakeholder expectations
- Balances the triple constraint:
 - ▶ **Scope** – What's included
 - ▶ **Time** – When it's delivered
 - ▶ **Cost** – Budget and resources

Project Life Cycle

1. **Initiation** – Define the project, identify stakeholders
2. **Planning** – Develop roadmap, schedule, budget, risk plan
3. **Execution** – Deliver work, monitor progress
4. **Closing** – Finalize deliverables, capture lessons learned

Methodologies

- **Waterfall** – Linear, phase-based approach
- **Agile** – Iterative, adaptive, feedback-driven
- **Lean** – Eliminate waste, maximize value
- **Six Sigma** – Reduce defects, improve quality
- **Hybrid** – Combine elements to suit context

Organizational Structures

- **Functional** – Departments manage their own work
- **Matrix** – Shared authority between PM and functional leads
- **Project-Oriented** – Teams formed around projects



PMO (Project Management Office)

- Sets standards and best practices
- Provides tools, templates, and training
- Supports governance and strategic alignment



Section 2: Initiation

SMART Goals

- Specific
- Measurable
- Achievable
- Relevant
- Time-bound

OKRs (Objectives & Key Results)

Objective : What you want to achieve

Key Results : How you measure success

Stakeholder Analysis

Use the Power/Interest Grid to classify stakeholders:

- High Power / High Interest → Manage closely
- High Power / Low Interest → Keep satisfied
- Low Power / High Interest → Keep informed
- Low Power / Low Interest → Monitor

Project Charter

A formal document that defines:

- Project purpose and scope
- Deliverables
- Roles and responsibilities



- Budget and timeline
- Risks and constraints
- Approval authority

Financial Fundamentals

- **Cost-Benefit Analysis** – Compare expected benefits vs. costs
- **ROI (Return on Investment)** – $ROI = (Gain - Cost) \div Cost$



Section 3: Planning

Planning & Execution Vocabulary

Scope	– The boundaries and deliverables of the project.
Milestone	– A significant event or checkpoint in the project timeline.
Dependency	– A task that relies on another task's completion.
Schedule	– A timeline for tasks and milestones.
Budget	– The financial resources allocated to the project.
Procurement	– Acquiring goods or services needed for the project.
Status Report	– A summary of progress, issues, and next steps.
Deliverable	– A completed output or product from the project.

Work Breakdown Structure (WBS)

- Break project into manageable components
- Organize by deliverables, phases, or functions
- Supports scheduling, budgeting, and accountability

Scheduling

- **Critical Path Method (CPM)** – Identify tasks that determine project duration
- **Dependencies:**
 - ▶ Finish-to-Start (FS)
 - ▶ Start-to-Start (SS)



- ▶ Finish-to-Finish (FF)
- ▶ Start-to-Finish (SF)

Budgeting

- Estimate costs by task or phase
- Include contingency reserves
- Track actual vs. planned costs

Procurement

- Define what to buy and from whom
- Select vendors
- Write contracts
- Monitor delivery and performance
- Ensure ethical conduct

Risk Management

- Identify risks
- Analyze probability and impact
- Prioritize and plan responses
- Monitor and control risks
- Use tools like Risk Register and Fishbone Diagram

Stakeholder & Communication Vocabulary

Stakeholder	– Anyone affected by or interested in the project.
Sponsor	– The person or group funding and supporting the project.
Client	– The recipient of the final product or service.
Team Member	– An individual contributing to project tasks.
Communication Plan	– A strategy for sharing information with stakeholders.
Escalation Path	– A defined route for resolving issues beyond the team's control.
Feedback Loop	– A system for collecting and responding to stakeholder input.



Communication & Team Management

- **RACI Chart:**
 - Responsible
 - Accountable
 - Consulted
 - Informed
- Plan meetings, updates, and feedback loops
- Clarify roles and expectations

Section 4: Execution

Tracking Progress

- Status Reports** – Use RAG (Red, Amber, Green) indicators
- Gantt Charts** – Visualize schedule and dependencies
- Burndown Charts** – Track work remaining in Agile projects

Quality Management

- Plan quality standards
- Assure compliance
- Control deliverables
- Conduct UAT (User Acceptance Testing)

Data-Informed Decisions

- Use metrics to guide choices
- Ensure data privacy and ethical use
- Avoid bias in interpretation



🧩 Risk & Change Vocabulary 🧩

Risk	– The possibility of an event impacting the project.
Risk Register	– A document listing identified risks, their severity, and mitigation plans.
Risk Analysis	– Evaluating the likelihood and impact of risks.
Risk Response	– Actions taken to reduce or eliminate risks.
Contingency Plan	– A backup strategy for high-impact risks.
Change Request	– A formal proposal to modify project scope, schedule, or deliverables.
Change Control Board (CCB)	– A group that reviews and approves change requests.
Change Log	– A record of all approved changes and their implementation status.

Managing Change & Risk

- Escalate issues appropriately
- Use ROAM Analysis:
 - ▶ Resolved
 - ▶ Owned
 - ▶ Accepted
 - ▶ Mitigated
- Provide “Air Cover” to protect the team from external pressure



Section 5: Agile & Scrum

Agile Methodology Vocabulary

Agile	– An approach to iterative software development.
Iterative	– A method involving repetition, evaluation, and refinement.
Incremental	– Delivering small portions of the end product.
Adaptive	– Adjusting processes based on feedback.
Value	– The perceived worth of a product by the customer.
Customer	– The end user or recipient of the team's services.
Transparency	– Sharing information and making processes observable.
Collaboration	– Stakeholders and team members working together constructively.
Self-Organization	– Team autonomy in determining methods and practices.
Cross-Functionality	– A team with varied knowledge and skills.
Sprint	– A work cycle typically lasting one to four weeks.
Sprint Planning	– A meeting to identify tasks for a sprint.
Daily Standup	– A brief daily meeting to review progress and plans.
Sprint Retrospective	– A reflection at the end of a sprint to identify improvements.

Agile Manifesto

Values:

- Individuals and interactions > Processes and tools
- Working software > Comprehensive documentation
- Customer collaboration > Contract negotiation
- Responding to change > Following a plan

Principles:

- Deliver frequently
- Welcome change
- Build projects around motivated individuals
- Reflect and improve regularly



Scrum Roles

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|----------------------|-------------------------------|
| Scrum Master | – Facilitates process |
| Product Owner | – Owns backlog and vision |
| Developers | – Build and deliver increment |

Scrum Artifacts

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|------------------------|-----------------------------|
| Product Backlog | – List of desired features |
| Sprint Backlog | – Tasks for current sprint |
| Increment | – Completed, usable product |

Scrum Events

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|------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Sprint | – Time-boxed development cycle |
| Sprint Planning | – Define sprint goal and tasks |
| Daily Scrum | – 15-minute team sync |
| Sprint Review | – Demo and feedback |
| Retrospective | – Reflect and improve |

✓ Section 6: Closing

Project Closure

- Confirm deliverables
- Obtain stakeholder sign-off
- Release resources

Post-Mortem

- Document lessons learned
- Identify successes and failures
- Recommend improvements

Impact Reporting

- Use metrics to show value
- Visual storytelling to communicate results
- Include ROI, customer satisfaction, and performance indicators



Section 7: Career Development with AI

AI in Job Search

- Resume writing with X-Y-Z formula
- Practice interviews with AI tools
- Tailor applications using job description analysis

AI in Project Work

- Draft charters
- Identify risks
- Map stakeholders
- Summarize meetings and decisions

Ethical AI Use

- Maintain human oversight
- Protect data integrity
- Disclose AI involvement responsibly